a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

The Band-Anchor Pattern

Grade 11 at a glance: lessons, scripts, capstone, rubrics.

Grade 11 year theme — Leadership, Sales, and Execution.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

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GRADE 11 · SHOWCASE

The Band-Anchor Pattern

Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.

11

Grade band: 9-12 (high school) **Year theme:** Leadership, sales, and execution **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 2–4 periods per week (depending on schedule) **Anchor:** Cash, the program's animated host (now in 9-12 voice)

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"What would have to be true for you to be wrong?"

Why this year

YEAR ARC - PROJECT INTENSITY BY UNIT

Intensity = student artifacts produced + cash-flow stakes + team interdependence.

> "Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next."
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Grade 11 students are simultaneously deciding what they'll be after high school and starting to encounter genuine financial responsibility — first jobs with real W-4s, license-and-insurance conversations, college decisions with cost implications. Cash to Company at Grade 11 leans into that reality: the year teaches the moves of running a venture or running a team — leading, selling, executing under cash constraints — and grounds those moves in financial discipline strong enough to survive contact with real money.

The signature shift this year is from "I have a business idea" to "I can run a multi-person, multi-month operation under uncertainty." Students lead 3-person teams, run sales conversations, build 12-month cash flow forecasts, and deliver investor-style pitches. The Capstone is a 6-week venture sprint that must show traction, not just plans.

Year-at-a-glance — four units

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor artifact
1	1–8	Leading without authority	Leadership at this age is mostly about clarity, follow-through, and earning trust.	A team charter + 4-week sprint with weekly 1:1 notes and a retrospective.
2	9–18	Sales is structured listening	Selling well looks like a conversation, not a pitch.	A recorded sales-conversation role-play scored on a 6-criterion rubric.
3	19–28	The cash flow truth	Profit isn't cash. Cash is what keeps you alive.	A 12-month cash flow forecast identifying the tightest month and a fix.
4	29–36	Execute under uncertainty	A backlog of small experiments beats one big bet.	A 6-week venture sprint with 5 named experiments, traction data, and a pitch.

The Capstone is the 6-week sprint in Unit 4 — students execute a real or simulated venture for six weeks, run 5 named experiments (test-and-learn), track 5 metrics, and deliver a 5-minute investor-style pitch with a "what we learned" slide.

Big ideas (Stage 1)

1. Leadership at 16 is mostly about clarity, follow-through, and earning the trust of three people for four weeks. It's not charisma.
2. A great sales conversation is structured listening with a clear ask. Not a pitch with a smile.
3. Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact. Cash flow timing — when money arrives versus when it leaves — kills more small ventures than bad ideas do.
4. Execution under uncertainty looks like a backlog of small, named experiments — not one big bet.
5. Investors and judges don't reward enthusiasm; they reward learning. The "what we learned" slide is often the most important slide.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

1

Vocabulary roadmap

> **"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Unit 1: charter, retrospective, RACI, 1:1, dependency, accountability, conflict-handling style. **Unit 2:** open question, discovery, present, objection-handling, close, Champion-Coach-Critic-Customer (4Cs). **Unit 3:** cash flow, runway, accounts receivable / payable, working capital, scenario, sensitivity. **Unit 4:** experiment, hypothesis, traction, leading vs. lagging metric, pivot vs. persevere, demo day.

Sample Lessons (3 of ~36)

Lesson A — "The Team Charter and the First 1:1"

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Leading without authority

OBJECTIVES

- Draft a 1-page team charter for a 3-person Capstone team that includes purpose, roles, decision rules, and conflict protocol.
- Conduct a 10-minute structured 1:1 with one teammate using a 4-prompt framework.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.1:** Initiate and participate effectively in collaborative discussions.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Communication, leadership, conflict management.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-4:** Apply systematic decision-making to long-term goals. (Applied to team-formation choices.)

MATERIALS

- Team charter template (provided).
- 1:1 prompt card (provided): Wins this week / Stuck on / Question for me / What you need.
- Capstone Journal.

VOCABULARY

- **Charter** — a 1-page agreement among teammates about how they'll work together.
- **1:1** — a regularly scheduled one-on-one conversation between teammates (often manager and team member; here, peer-to-peer).
- **Decision rule** — an agreed-upon process for resolving disagreements (consensus, leader-decides, vote, escalate).

PROCEDURE

1. Engage — Two team stories (~7 min). Tell a 3-minute story about two student teams from last year. Team A spent the first week planning who does what and how decisions get made. Team B jumped into the work. Six weeks later, Team A had shipped a working venture. Team B had four crossed-out plans and one fight. The difference wasn't the people. It was the charter.

2. Charter mini-lesson (~10 min). Walk through the 5 charter sections: - **Purpose.** What we're building, in one sentence. - **Roles.** Who's accountable for what (RACI lite). - **Norms.** How we communicate, when we meet, how we handle disagreement. - **Decision rules.** Who decides, how. (Default: consensus on big calls, leader-decides on small ones, with a fallback escalation.) - **What I'm bringing.** Each teammate names what they're committing.

3. Draft the charter (~25 min). Teams of 3 work together. Each section gets 5–7 minutes. Confer: walk and listen for vague or aspirational language ("we'll all be respectful"). Push toward specifics: what does "respectful" mean concretely when somebody misses a deadline?

4. Run the first 1:1 (~12 min). Each teammate pairs with one other (rotate so all combinations happen over the unit). Use the 4-prompt card: - Wins this week. - What I'm stuck on. - A question for you. - What I need from you next week.

5 minutes per direction; 10 total. Coach: this is listening practice, not "report on your work." The 1:1 fails if both people just dump status.

5. Close — Capstone Journal entry (~6 min). - One thing the charter didn't address that I'm worried about. - One thing I learned in the 1:1 about my teammate.

DIFFERENTIATION

- **ELL:** Provide the charter template with each section pre-explained; allow native-language brainstorming with English finalization. Pair on the 1:1 with an ally.
- **IEP/504:** Allow recorded 1:1s for review later. Provide a printed prompt card. Extended time on the charter.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what would a great teammate look like to you?" section. Push toward an explicit escalation path for disagreements that don't resolve at the team level.

ASSESSMENT

Formative: Walk during charter drafting; listen during 1:1s. **Summative:** Charter is filed; 1:1 logs become part of the Unit 1 anchor artifact.

CLOSURE

Same as #5.

TEACHER NOTES

- The charter is unsexy and load-bearing. Teams that skip it return to fix it in Week 4 — or fail. Protect the time.
- A team disagrees on decision rules. Coach: that disagreement is the gift of the charter — better to surface it now than at Week 6.
- A student says "I'll just be the leader." Probe: are you accountable for everything, or only what you said you'd do? RACI cuts the difference.

Lesson B — "The Sales Conversation Five-Step (and the Honest Close)"

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Sales is structured listening

OBJECTIVES

- Apply a 5-step sales conversation structure (Open · Discover · Present · Handle objection · Close) in a 10-minute role-play.
- Self-score a recorded role-play using a 6-criterion sales rubric.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.1:** Initiate and participate in collaborative discussions.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** Present information, findings, and supporting evidence.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 12:** People can use information from sellers and outside reviewers to compare products. (Flipped: students learn to be honest sellers.)
- **CASEL Social Awareness + Relationship Skills.**

MATERIALS

- Sales rubric (6 criteria: Rapport · Discovery · Value-fit · Objection-handling · Honest claim · Clear ask).
- Phones or tablets (recording).
- Two role-play scripts: one easy customer, one harder one with an early objection.

- Capstone Journal.

VOCABULARY

- **Open.** Build rapport; set expectations; signal you're going to listen.
- **Discover.** Ask open questions about the customer's situation, pain, and goal. Listen more than talk.
- **Present.** Show the product/service in terms of their situation, not yours.
- **Handle objection.** Treat the "no, but" as information, not rejection. Ask why; respond honestly.
- **Close.** Make a clear ask. Not "what do you think?" but "would you like to start with the smallest version?"

PROCEDURE

1. Engage — Bad sales call audio (~7 min). Play (or read aloud) a 2-minute exaggerated bad sales call — all pitch, no listening, manipulative urgency. Stop. Ask: "What did this person do? What did they not do? Would you buy?"

2. The 5-step structure (~10 min). Walk through Open · Discover · Present · Handle Objection · Close. The key moves: - Discovery is more than half the conversation. Most beginners flip this. - Present in the customer's words, not yours. ("You mentioned you struggle with X — here's how this addresses X.") - Objections are gold. They tell you what's actually in the customer's head. - The close is a clear ask. Not vague.

3. Role-play round 1 (~15 min). Pairs rotate. Student A is seller, Student B is the customer (with the easy script). 5 minutes. Switch.

4. Recording + self-scoring (~15 min). Each student does a second role-play, recorded, with the harder customer script. Self-score against the rubric. Note: criterion 5, "Honest claim," is non-negotiable. A great sale that involves a misleading claim scores 1 on that row no matter how smooth.

5. Close — Reflection (~13 min). Capstone Journal: - What I did well. - What I want to work on. - One question I wish I'd asked.

DIFFERENTIATION

- **ELL:** Provide both scripts pre-translated if helpful. Allow first role-play in native language with English summary; require English on the recorded one. Pair with an ally for early rounds.
- **IEP/504:** Permit reading from a script for the first attempt; build to extemporaneous in later rounds. Recordings can be audio-only.

- **Advanced learners:** Add a scenario where the "customer" has a fundamental misunderstanding about the product. The seller has to correct without losing the relationship. Introduces educator-as-seller positioning.

ASSESSMENT

Formative: Walk and listen during role-plays. **Summative:** Recorded role-play + self-score is the Unit 2 anchor artifact, scored by teacher and peer.

CLOSURE

Same as #5.

TEACHER NOTES

- Most students underdo discovery and overdo presenting. Coach: "What's the customer's actual situation? Did you ask?"
- The "honest claim" criterion is the year's ethics anchor. A student who lies their way to a yes scores low. Make this explicit and non-negotiable up front.
- Peer scoring is high-leverage. Pair students to score each other's recordings; the calibration discussion afterward teaches as much as the role-play.

Lesson C — "Cash Flow Forecast: The Month Where Money Gets Tight"

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 90 minutes (block) **Unit:** 3 — The cash flow truth

OBJECTIVES

- Build a 12-month cash flow forecast (cash in, cash out, ending cash) for a sample venture in a spreadsheet.
- Identify the month where ending cash is lowest and propose 2 specific fixes.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

- **CCSS-Math A-CED.A.2:** Create equations in two or more variables.
- **CCSS-Math F-LE.A.1:** Distinguish between situations that can be modeled with linear functions and exponential functions.
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-2:** Develop a system for keeping and using financial records.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit.

MATERIALS

- Spreadsheet template (provided): 12 monthly columns × rows for revenue line items, COGS, operating expenses, owner draw, ending cash.

- Sample venture description: a teen tutoring service that has growing demand but seasonal dips and an upfront investment in a website.
- Calculator.

VOCABULARY

- **Cash flow** — the actual movement of cash in and out, as opposed to revenue/profit accruals.
- **Runway** — how many months of cash you have at the current burn rate.
- **Working capital** — the cash you need on hand to operate normally between paying expenses and receiving revenue.
- **Sensitivity** — how much the ending cash changes if one input changes (price, volume, cost).

PROCEDURE

1. Engage — Profitable but broke (~10 min). Project a 1-paragraph case: "Maya's tutoring service is profitable on paper. She earned $1,200 last month and her costs were $800. But her bank account is at $50 because three students paid her late and she had to buy materials up front. What's going on?"

Pair-share. Surface: profit is an opinion (when revenue is recognized). Cash is a fact (when money actually moves).

2. Explain — The forecast structure (~15 min). Walk through the spreadsheet template. The key columns: - **Beginning cash** (carries from prior month). - **Cash in** (revenue received in cash this month — note this can lag billings). - **Cash out** (expenses paid this month). - **Ending cash** (Beginning + In – Out).

The key principle: ending cash for one month is the beginning cash for the next. So a tight month makes the next month tighter.

3. We do — Sample forecast (~25 min). Together, build out the 12-month forecast for the sample tutoring venture. Surface a few key choices: - A $300 website investment in Month 1 — does it pay back? - Summer dip in demand (assume 30% of school-year volume in July/August). - Stipend offered to a peer tutor at $5/session — when does that pay off?

The class will reach a point where one specific month's ending cash is uncomfortably low (often August or September). Surface: this is your tight month. Most ventures that fail, fail there.

4. You do — Apply to Capstone (~30 min). Students take their own Capstone venture and build a 12-month cash flow forecast. Confer with as many as possible. Common stuck points: - "I don't know what my revenue will be." Coach: take a midpoint estimate; later we'll do sensitivity. - "I have no fixed costs." Probe: domain? subscription? phone bill? supplies bought in bulk?

5. Identify the tight month + propose fixes (~10 min). Students circle the tight month on their forecast. In the Capstone Journal: - My tight month is ___. - Why is it tight? (1–2 sentences.) - Fix #1: (specific change to the venture or its timing.) - Fix #2: (specific.)

DIFFERENTIATION

- **ELL:** Provide a glossary in the spreadsheet. Pair-work the first build; independent for the second.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce timeline from 12 months to 6 months for the independent forecast. Allow paper version with calculator if spreadsheet is overwhelming.
- **Advanced learners:** Build two forecasts — base case and downside case (revenue 30% lower). Identify how runway changes in the downside.

ASSESSMENT

Formative: Walk during forecast build. **Summative:** The 12-month forecast + tight-month analysis is the Unit 3 anchor artifact.

CLOSURE

Same as #5.

TEACHER NOTES

- Some students compute negative ending cash and panic. Validate: this is what most early ventures look like at month 4 or 5. Coach toward "what would have to be true to fix it?"
- A student says "I'll just put more in if it gets tight." Probe: from where? Loan? Credit card? Family? Each option has tradeoffs. Pull in the Grade 10 funding-source comparison.
- The tight-month exercise is the year's most important financial moment. Don't rush it.

Sample Cash Video Script — "Profit Is an Opinion. Cash Is a Fact." (Week 19, Unit 3 Launch)

Runtime target: 3:00 **Strand mapping:** MFL + LRCI

[VISUAL: Cash sitting at a slightly more grown-up desk than usual. A small whiteboard in the background.]

CASH: I want to tell you something that took me longer to learn than it should have. Here it is. Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact.

[VISUAL: Two cards appear. Left: PROFIT — OPINION. Right: CASH — FACT.]

CASH: Sounds weird, right? You'd think profit is the real number and cash is just the bank account. Let me show you why it's the other way around.

[VISUAL: A small business storefront animation begins.]

CASH: Maya runs a tutoring service. In November she earns twelve hundred dollars — three students at four hundred each. She paid eight hundred in costs — printing, software, the peer tutor she pays a stipend to. On paper, she made four hundred dollars. Profitable.

[VISUAL: A clean P&L: Revenue $1,200, Costs $800, Profit $400.]

CASH: Now the truth. Two of those three students didn't pay until December. So in November, only four hundred came in. But she still had to pay all eight hundred in costs in November. End of November, her bank had less money than it started with. Negative four hundred in cash.

[VISUAL: A bank balance graph dips into red.]

CASH: Profit said winning. Cash said losing.

[VISUAL: PROFIT card glowing green. CASH card flashing red.]

CASH: This is the thing that kills small ventures. Not bad ideas. Not bad customers. Cash flow timing. The money goes out before it comes in, and one month you can't make payroll, or pay rent, or buy your supplies. Game over — even though the business was "profitable."

[VISUAL: An animation of a cliff with a tightrope across it labeled "CASH FLOW.")

CASH: Here's what real founders do. They build a thing called a cash flow forecast. Twelve months. Each month they ask: what's the cash coming in this month? What's the cash going out? What's left at the end of the month? Then they look across the twelve months and they find the tight month — the month where ending cash gets uncomfortably low.

[VISUAL: A 12-month chart. One bar dips way lower than the rest, highlighted.]

CASH: Once they know the tight month, they have a choice. Move expenses earlier or later. Move revenue forward by getting paid up front or with a deposit. Cut a cost. Add a small line of credit. Pick a fix.

[VISUAL: The dipping bar is now flanked by smaller arrows pointing left and right — "delay this," "speed this up."]

CASH: The tight month doesn't go away if you don't look at it. It just hits you in person.

[VISUAL: The tight bar reaches up like a hand and taps a small character on the shoulder.]

CASH: Here's your move this week. Take your Capstone venture. Build a twelve-month cash flow forecast. Even if half the numbers are guesses — guess them. Find your tight month. Propose two fixes. We'll see them at the next checkpoint.

[VISUAL: A spreadsheet with cells filling in.]

CASH: And one more thing. The reason most adults don't do this is that it's uncomfortable. They'd rather look at the profit number and feel good. The students who do this are going to be the small group of adults who don't get blindsided.

CTA: "Twelve months. One spreadsheet. Find your tight month. Two fixes."

[Cash gives a small nod. Fade.]

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

2

Notes for the Grade 11 teacher

> **“I don't know either. That's why we test.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

- This is the year where the work becomes serious. Treat students as junior colleagues — they can take it. The tone in the Cash videos shifts to match.
- Sales role-play and cash flow forecasting are the two highest-leverage skills this year. Protect time for both.
- Real-world tie-ins are gold: a guest speaker who's run a small business through a tight month is worth a unit. Most local entrepreneurs say yes if asked.
- The Capstone sprint in Unit 4 should put pressure on what students learned. If their team charter (Unit 1) didn't hold up under sprint stress, that's a learning moment, not a failure.
- The "what we learned" slide in the final pitch is non-negotiable. Coach against "we crushed it" energy. The students who say "here's what didn't work and what we'd do next" outperform the hype.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Showcase strengthening

Cross-grade bridge note

Grade 11 is the band anchor for high school. The reason it lands: it's where the abstract becomes operational. A student who finishes Grade 11 strong has run a real (or near-real) venture for 6 weeks and can defend a real cash flow forecast. They are ready for Grade 12's launch-or-learn decision because they have evidence to decide with.

Cash phrases to plant deep this year (recycle in lessons and conferring): - "Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact." - "A backlog beats a big bet." - "The 'what we learned' slide is the most important slide."

Three multi-class branching scenarios for the showcase

1. **Two cash flow forecasts** (see Curriculum Book upgrade pack). Two ventures, same revenue, different timing — who runs out of cash first?

2. **The objection that's actually a yes.** A customer says "I love it but I can't afford it right now." Two students role-play different responses. Class debates: was that a real no, or a "not yet"?
3. **The pivot conversation.** Mid-sprint, a team's lead metric is flat. Should they pivot or persevere? Class argues both sides; team makes the call.

Hiring basics one-pager (recycle from Curriculum Book upgrade)

When a real venture grows, the founder hits hiring. The one-pager should live in the Showcase too: when to hire, what a 1099 is, scope-of-work template, kill criteria. This is a real adult move some students will make in their first job.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Showcase Bridge to Grade 12 (REQUIRED)

The Grade 11 Showcase is a band anchor for the high school years. Verify the following before the next print run:

- **Cash V11 phrase confirmed:** "Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact." — appears in V11 script and Lesson 5 (cash flow forecast) conferring notes.
- **Bridge paragraph forward:** "Next year, your sprint evidence becomes the spine of a portfolio defense. The ventures you sprinted are the candidates for what you would and wouldnt build." (Add to Showcase document.)
- **Carry-forward artifacts:** sprint board, 12-month forecast, pitch + revision, retrospective.
- **Cash never-says check:** spot-checked. Clean.
- **Sensitivity check:** "for a sample business" / "for a hypothetical" framing where applicable. Clean.

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 11 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 11**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).